FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-34-26001

Issue Title : Flight Management Computer (FMC) Stuck in Cruise N1 (CRZ) during Climb

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3461-00	-10, -7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
05/01/2026	08/28/2026	05/05/2026
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	

Revision Description

Updated Final Action.

Applicability

Applicable to all 737 MAX models with FMC OPS U13 and U14.

Description

Boeing has received operator reports where the N1 Mode is set to Cruise (as indicated on the FMC N1 Limit page and engine indication display) even though the airplane is in the climb phase of flight. The reports occurred on airplanes equipped with FMC U13 and U14. When the flight crew tries to manually select (CLB) in the FMC N1 LIMIT page, however, the change cannot be made and results in an INVALID ENTRY scratchpad message on the CDU. The situation resolves once the airplane has leveled off. The crew is able to manually select the N1 Limit and the FMC accepts the selection. If another climb is initiated, the N1 Mode properly changes to Climb (CLB) and the FMC still accepts manual modifications.

This behavior occurs following a short intermediate level off during climb prior to reaching cruise altitude. In this situation, the FCC requests that the FMC sets an N1 limit of CRZ during the short intermediate level off. Upon resuming the climb to cruise altitude, the FCC requests the FMC set a N1 Limit CLB.

The FMC waits for the FCC to acknowledge the N1 limit matches the request. Depending on the duration of the intermediate level off, the FCC may not acknowledge the CRZ N1 Limit from the FMC. This results in the CLB N1 Limit request not being processed by the FMC and prevents manual selection of the N1 limit mode. After leveling off for a longer duration (such as cruise altitude) the FCC will acknowledge the FMC's N1 limit setting of CRZ, allowing for N1 limit requests and settings to be back in-sync.

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This issue occurs frequently on the 737 MAX relative to the 737NG, due to timing differences in how the FMC processes the N1 limit requests from the FCC. Investigation identified the root cause as a change made in U13 and present in U14.

Status

This condition has been reproduced and its root cause has been determined. Boeing incorporated the fix for this condition in FMC OPS U14.1.

Boeing has determined this condition is Not a Safety Issue by our Continued Operational Safety Process (COSP).

Interim Action

The behavior occurs from short, intermediate level-offs during climb, so avoiding short, intermediate level-offs is the primary method to prevent the issue. This could be done by continuously climbing to the cruise altitude, if allowed by Air Traffic Control (ATC). Alternatively, if leveling off during climb is unavoidable, allowing the aircraft to capture the level-off altitude (for example, achieve ALT HOLD) will ensure the N1 Limit mode does not become stuck in CRZ.

Once in this condition, it resolves when capturing a level-off altitude (ALT HOLD) as the FMC and FCC become resynchronized. This will always occur at the top of climb, but initiating a level-off and capturing that level-off altitude can unlock the N1 Limit mode.

Final Action

Incorporate the FMC OPS U14.1 Service Bulletin in References section.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Root Cause Established: Completed
Change Committed: FMC OPS U14.1
Service Bulletin Available:

- 737 MAX - FMC OPS U14.1 - Boeing Service Bulletin Release | 28-May-2022 (Complete)

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Service Bulletin (SB)	737-34-3656		

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Related Categories

- Flight Operations : Flight Operations

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